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STUDENT HANDOUT

RED LEVEL
GO DEEPER

Stories of a Great Journey

Grades 1–2

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

Challenge Context: Between 1910 and 1940, over one million Black Americans fled the Jim Crow South — escaping segregation, economic exploitation, and racial violence — to build new lives in Northern cities. In Harlem, this became the most concentrated explosion of Black creative talent in history. The people who made the Harlem Renaissance weren't just escaping something. They were building something.

ACTIVITY 1 · THE INTERVIEW

A voice from the journey

You are a journalist in 1920. You are interviewing a family boarding a train heading north. Write their answers in full sentences:

Q: Where are you from, and why are you leaving?

Q: What do you hope to find in the North?

Q: What one thing could you never leave behind — and why?

Think Deeper: What is the difference between leaving a place and escaping a place? Does that difference change how we should think about the Great Migration?

ACTIVITY 2 · RESEARCH A REAL VOICE

One person from the Harlem Renaissance

Choose one person below. Use the exhibition, books, or online resources to find three facts about them:

Langston Hughes | Zora Neale Hurston | Bessie Smith | Duke Ellington | Aaron Douglas | Walter F. White

I chose: _____ They were a: _____

Fact 1: _____

Fact 2: _____

Fact 3: _____

Why does this person's work still matter today?

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

Deep dive: Explore *The Fire in the Flint* exhibit — Walter F. White looked white but fought for Black civil rights his entire life. Visit the Great Migration Map and trace the journey city by city.

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Family research project: Together, search for 2–3 songs from the era (try "Bessie Smith" or "Duke Ellington 1920s"). Listen and discuss: What do you hear? What might life have been like when this was recorded?